BREAD OF LIFE
FEED • SHELTER • EMPOWER

COMMUNITY NEWSLETTER
Fall 2026 Edition
Augusta, Maine

FEATURE STORY

A Story of Resilience and Hope: Patrick's Journey

Highlighting life overcoming hardship, unyielding courage, and the power of transitional veteran support.

Today, we share the story of **Patrick** — a life shaped by profound hardship, extraordinary resilience, and an unwavering drive to keep moving forward.

Born in 1960 in the Battleboro neighborhood of Rocky Mount, North Carolina, Patrick was the youngest of nine children. Raised by a mother whose deep faith anchored the family after his father passed away during his infancy, Patrick grew up singing in the junior church choir and learning lifelong lessons about ethics, dignity, and perseverance.

In 1978, Patrick enlisted in the U.S. Army, serving three years at Fort Bragg and in Heilbronn, Germany as a Communications Operator for General Beckton — a prominent three-star African American general. For Patrick, serving under General Beckton demonstrated what was possible before earning his honorable discharge in 1981.

> *"We are looking at the person: what they need, where they come from, and the next steps that will work best."*
>
> **— Victoria Abbott, Executive Director**

Following military service, life brought unexpected struggles. Addiction crept in, eroding stability and leading to homelessness. Misfortune deepened when Patrick was wrongfully charged, convicted, and incarcerated for five years for a crime he did not commit — during which his mother passed away firmly believing in his innocence.

Determined to turn his life around, Patrick arrived in Maine sober and focused. He embraced Bread of Life's programs with complete dedication and was accepted into the **Vets Inc. program** — a transitional housing community for unhoused veterans providing clinical case management, health services, employment training, and permanent housing placement.



Patrick celebrating at Bread of Life Staff Day alongside staff team members.

July Impact Snapshot

4,465+	68	15
MEALS SERVED	SHELTERED	HOUSED

Every meal and safe shelter bed represents dignity and a pathway toward permanent community stability.

Community Connection: Bread of Life Annual Staff Day

Behind every hot meal served and shelter bed provided is our dedicated staff team! This month, the Bread of Life family gathered along the Kennebec River at Cushnoc Brewing Co. for our annual **Staff Appreciation Day**.

- **Team Unity:** Sharing meals and celebrating our shared mission serving Augusta.
- **Cornhole Tournament:** Staff competed in a friendly waterfront tournament with custom trophies!
- **Daily Heart:** Honoring our kitchen cooks, shelter intake team, and case managers.



Staff enjoying outdoor games along the riverfront.

OUR MISSION

Bread of Life feeds the hungry, shelters the homeless, and provides services that empower people to change their lives and take personal responsibility.